

# US Patent & Trademark Office

## Patent Public Search | Text View

---

|                      |                      |
|----------------------|----------------------|
| United States Patent | 12388734             |
| Kind Code            | B2                   |
| Date of Patent       | August 12, 2025      |
| Inventor(s)          | Han; Sunyoung et al. |

---

### Cluster availability monitoring and alerting

---

#### Abstract

Systems and methods include execution of a first instance of a first service in an execution environment, transmission of a ping to an external port of the first instance, determination of a ping result corresponding to the transmitted ping, storage of metadata indicating a status of the first instance of the first service, determination of a health status metric of the first instance and providing the health status metric via an internal port of the execution environment, and determination of whether to generate an alert associated with the first instance based on the ping result, the status, and the health status metric.

---

**Inventors:** Han; Sunyoung (Seoul, KR), Kim; Young Hun (Bucheon, KR), Park; Jongheon (Yongin-si, KR), Kim; Incheol (Incheon, KR), Kang; Jihun (Seoul, KR), Lee; Chul Won (Seoul, KR)

**Applicant:** SAP SE (Walldorf, DE)

**Family ID:** 88875932

**Assignee:** SAP SE (Walldorf, DE)

**Appl. No.:** 17/826965

**Filed:** May 27, 2022

#### Prior Publication Data

|                            |                         |
|----------------------------|-------------------------|
| <b>Document Identifier</b> | <b>Publication Date</b> |
| US 20230388205 A1          | Nov. 30, 2023           |

---

#### Publication Classification

**Int. Cl.:** H04L43/065 (20220101); G06F11/30 (20060101); H04L43/10 (20220101)

**U.S. Cl.:**

CPC     **H04L43/065** (20130101); **G06F11/3006** (20130101); **G06F11/3055** (20130101);  
**H04L43/10** (20130101);

## Field of Classification Search

**CPC:**    H04L (43/10); H04L (43/065); G06F (11/3055); G06F (11/3006)

---

## References Cited

### U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

| Patent No.   | Issued Date | Patentee Name | U.S. Cl. | CPC          |
|--------------|-------------|---------------|----------|--------------|
| 10630566     | 12/2019     | Nguyen        | N/A      | H04L 43/0817 |
| 11895194     | 12/2023     | Markuze       | N/A      | H04L 67/10   |
| 2016/0380916 | 12/2015     | Gnaneswaran   | 709/224  | H04L 47/803  |
| 2022/0138070 | 12/2021     | Mokashi       | 709/224  | G06F 9/5072  |

---

*Primary Examiner:* Smith; Marcus

*Assistant Examiner:* Fakhro; Rowan K

*Attorney, Agent or Firm:* Buckley, Maschoff & Talwalkar LLC

---

## Background/Summary

### BACKGROUND

- (1) Modern system landscapes consist of multiple computing services provided by disparate computing hardware. In some cases, the computing services may be centrally managed. For example, a central orchestration service may manage different data storage services such as a cloud relational database, a data lake, and an OnLine Transaction Processing (OLTP) database.
- (2) Cloud computing technologies have drastically increased the number of computing service instances which may be provided within a system landscape. In the above example, the system landscape may include thousands of instances of the cloud relational database. Centralized monitoring of such a large number of service instances is problematic.
- (3) For example, service instance monitoring in such cases may simply include periodic transmission of a ping to an external port of each service instance. The result of the ping is reviewed to determine whether an alert should be generated. If so, the alert (e.g., service offline) is presented to an associated operations team.
- (4) The above approach may result in an undesirable number of false positive alerts. For example, a ping may timeout even if a service instance is online because all existing Structured Query Language (SQL) execution threads which service incoming SQL requests are currently occupied. Nevertheless, the timeout may result in issuance of an alert, the processing of which consumes resources unnecessarily.
- (5) What is needed are systems to monitor service availability while reducing the occurrence of false positives.
- 

## Description

## BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a block diagram of an architecture to monitor service instances according to some embodiments.
- (2) FIG. 2 is a block diagram of an architecture to monitor service instances according to some embodiments.
- (3) FIG. 3 is a flow diagram of a process to monitor service instances according to some embodiments.
- (4) FIG. 4 is a state diagram of a service instance according to some embodiments.
- (5) FIG. 5 is a tabular representation of metric and metadata values, and corresponding alert-related presumptions according to some embodiments.
- (6) FIG. 6 is a block diagram of an architecture to monitor service instances according to some embodiments.
- (7) FIG. 7 is a view of a user interface presenting an alert generated according to some embodiments.
- (8) FIG. 8 is a block diagram of a cloud-based system according to some embodiments.

## DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (9) The following description is provided to enable any person in the art to make and use the described embodiments. Various modifications, however, will be readily-apparent to those in the art.
- (10) According to some embodiments, a ping agent is assigned to an application upon execution of the application. The ping agent is operated to ping an external port of the application and obtain a ping result. A health status metric is also obtained from a health check mechanism accessible via an internal port of the application. Next, it is determined whether to generate an alert based on the ping result, the health status metric, and status metadata of the application (e.g., RUNNING, STOPPED, DELETED). Advantageously, it may be determined to not generate a result even if the ping fails, if, for example, the status metadata indicates that the application is running and the health status metric indicates that the application is reachable.
- (11) Embodiments may thereby reduce a number of false positive alerts. Such false positive alerts can be avoided in cases where the application is heavily loaded (e.g., with respect to memory or processor utilization) or the number of permitted connections has reached a limit.
- (12) FIG. 1 is a block diagram of architecture **100** according to some embodiments. The illustrated elements of architecture **100** and of all other architectures depicted herein may be implemented using any suitable combination of computing hardware and/or processor-executable program code that is or becomes known. Such combinations may include one or more programmable processors (microprocessors, central processing units, microprocessor cores, execution threads), one or more non-transitory electronic storage media, and processor-executable program code. In some embodiments, two or more elements of architecture **100** are implemented by a single computing device, and/or two or more elements of architecture **100** are co-located. One or more elements of architecture **100** may be implemented using cloud-based resources, and/or other systems which apportion computing resources elastically according to demand, need, price, and/or any other metric.
- (13) Ping service **110** may comprise processor-executable program code executing suitable hardware to communicate with orchestrator **120** and execution environments **130**, **140** and **150**. Orchestrator **120** may be responsible for maintaining the desired states of execution environments **130**, **140** and **150**. The current states of execution environments **130**, **140** and **150** may be stored in service metadata **124** and acquired by ping service **110** via service status API **122**.
- (14) Execution environments **130**, **140** and **150** may comprise separate hardware servers or separate virtual machines. One or more of execution environments **130**, **140** and **150** may execute within a single server or virtual machine. In some embodiments, each of execution environments **130**, **140**

and **150** comprises a container in which a containerized application may be executed and managed. Such containers may be implemented by one or more nodes of a cluster (e.g., a Kubernetes cluster) as is known in the art.

(15) The following description of the components of execution environment **130** may similarly apply to corresponding components of execution environments **140** and **150**. Ping service **110** may transmit a ping to an external (e.g., SQL) port of edge router **133**. The external port of edge router **133** may comprise a port accessible by users (not shown) of service **132**. Ping service **110** stores results of such pings as ping results **144** of data **140**. Ping results **144** may comprise a success flag (e.g., Y/N) and a reason for a failed ping result, if applicable (e.g., timeout, connection failed). Ping service **110** also stores acquired service metadata associated with the statuses of each service of environments **130**, **140** and **150** as service metadata **142**.

(16) Environment **130** also includes internal health check **134** to determine information regarding the health of service **132**. Internal health check **134** may be accessed via an internal port of execution environment **130** (i.e., a port which is not accessible to external users). Systems for accessing information determined by internal health check **134** will be described below. In the meantime, it is noted that the information determined by internal health check **134** may be acquired and also stored in data **141** as health metrics **146**.

(17) Data **141** may comprise any one or more data structures which need not be co-located. Data **141** may include service metadata **142**, ping results **144** and health metrics **146** for each service to be monitored.

(18) In this regard, alerting service **151** may operate to apply alert rules **155** to data **141** in order to determine whether to generate corresponding alerts. An alert rule **155** may evaluate most-recent service metadata **142**, ping results **144** and health metrics **146** associated with a service and determine whether to generate and present an alert to operations team **160** based thereon. Examples of such alert rules will be provided below.

(19) FIG. 2 illustrates architecture **200** according to some embodiments. Execution environments **230**, **240** and **250** may be implemented and operate as described above with respect to execution environments **130**, **140** and **150**. In this regard, orchestrator **210** may be responsible for maintaining the desired states of execution environments **230**, **240** and **250**.

(20) Ping service **215** of architecture **200** is implemented within orchestrator **210**. Accordingly, ping service **215** may directly access (i.e., without use of an API) service metadata **242** which is stored within orchestrator **210** and indicates the statuses of execution environments **230**, **240** and **250**.

(21) Ping service **210** may transmit a ping to an external port of edge router **233** of environment **230** or to an edge router associated with either of environments **240** and **250**. Ping service **210** stores results of such pings as ping results **244** of data **240**. Data **240** also stores health metrics determined by internal health check **234** as described above.

(22) Alerting service **251** of orchestrator **210** may operate to apply alert rules **255** to data **240** in order to determine whether to generate corresponding alerts. Any generated alerts may be presented to operations team **260**, which may act thereon.

(23) FIG. 3 comprises a flow diagram of process **300** according to some embodiments. Process **300** and all other processes mentioned herein may be embodied in program code executable by one or more processing units (e.g., processor, processor core, processor thread) and read from one or more of non-transitory computer-readable media, such as a hard disk drive, a volatile or non-volatile random access memory, a DVD-ROM, a Flash drive, and a magnetic tape, and then stored in a compressed, uncompiled and/or encrypted format. In some embodiments, hard-wired circuitry may be used in place of, or in combination with, program code for implementation of processes according to some embodiments. Embodiments are therefore not limited to any specific combination of hardware and software.

(24) At **S310**, the creation of a containerized application is identified. Although process **300** relates

to containerized applications, embodiments are not limited thereto. The creation of a containerized application may be identified based on a lifecycle event which represents creation of the containerized application.

(25) In some examples of **S310**, a command to instruct creation of a containerized application is provided to an orchestrator such as orchestrator **120** or orchestrator **210**. The containerized application may be considered a service instance, as the two terms are used interchangeably herein. The orchestrator updates corresponding metadata to indicate the creation of the containerized application and the updated metadata is analyzed by a ping service (located within or outside orchestrator **120**) to identify the creation of the containerized application.

(26) FIG. **4** is a state diagram of a service instance according to some embodiments. As shown, a request may be received to provision an instance prior to process **300**. Such a request generates metadata which associates the CREATING state with the new service instance. This state transitions to the STARTING state (which results in updating of the associated metadata) until the service instance reaches the RUNNING state. From the RUNNING state, lifecycle events may occur which cause the service instance to transition through the DELETING state to the DELETED state, or from the STOPPING state to the STOPPED state. In addition, the service instance may transition from the STOPPED state through the STARTING state to the RUNNING state, or from the STOPPED state through the DELETING state to the DELETED state. All state changes may be reflected in the metadata (e.g., **142**, **242**) associated with the service instance and maintained by the orchestrator.

(27) A ping agent is assigned to the containerized application at **S320**. According to some embodiments, a ping agent may be assigned to up to a certain number (e.g., 30) of containerized applications. Accordingly, if an existing ping agent instance is already assigned to the certain number of containerized applications, a new ping agent instance may be created at **S320** and assigned to the newly-created application.

(28) In some embodiments, the ping agent assigned to a containerized application depends on the type of the containerized application. For example, a first ping agent may be assigned only to cloud database service instances, while a second ping agent may be assigned only to OLTP instances. Accordingly, embodiments may include several instances of the first ping agent and several instances of the second ping agent, each of which is assigned to one or more of their corresponding type of service instances.

(29) At **S330**, the assigned ping agent is operated to ping an external port of the application and obtain a ping result. The external port may be accessible to users, such as an SQL endpoint. The ping result may include a success flag and a reason as described above.

(30) Next, at **S340**, a health status metric associated with the application is acquired from an internal port of the application. The internal port comprises a port which is not accessible to external users and which allows access to an internal health check mechanism. The health status metric may indicate reachability (i.e., connectivity), memory state, CPU consumption, etc.

(31) At **S350**, it is determined whether to generate an alert based on the ping result, the health status metric and the service metadata of the application. Use of these three parameters may result in fewer false positive alerts than systems in which only one or two of these parameters are considered. If it is determined not to generate an alert, flow returns to **S330** and continues as described above. In this regard, **S330** and **S340** may be executed in parallel according to respective periodic schedules (i.e., the frequency of execution of **S330** and **S340** need not be identical).

(32) FIG. **5** shows tabular representation **500** of metric values, metadata values and corresponding alert-related presumptions which may be used to determine whether to generate an alert according to some embodiments at **S350**. The columns Ping Result and Ping Result Reason represent information which may be acquired at **S330**, and the columns Service Stopped Flag and Operations Complete Flag represent service metadata according to some embodiments. The values of Service Stopped Flag and Operations Complete Flag may be used to determine a status of a corresponding

service instance, but embodiments are not limited to this status-related service metadata. For example, the service metadata used at **S350** may simply comprise an identifier of one of the states shown in FIG. 3.

(33) The Health Status Metric column of FIG. 5 represents health status metrics acquired at **S340**. These metrics may be acquired from an internal health check mechanism accessed via an internal port of a containerized application as described above.

(34) The Presumed Service State and Presumed Load/Health columns for a given row provide presumptions based on the values present in the Ping Result, Ping Result Reason, Service Stopped Flag, Operations Complete Flag and Health Status Metric columns of the given row. Based on these presumptions, the Alert Generated column indicates whether an alert should be generated. The use of a ping result, a health status metric, and service metadata as described herein allows more accurate presumptions, and therefore more appropriate alert generation, than otherwise available.

(35) For example, if the Ping Result is usually successful but occasionally fails due to a read timeout, the Service Stopped Flag is False and the Operations Complete Flag is True, prior systems may issue an alert. In some embodiments, the Health Status Metric in such a scenario may be Healthy and it is therefore presumed that the service is RUNNING and is simply highly loaded. Accordingly, no alert may be generated. In this regard, the internal port from which the health status metric is obtained may be associated with its own thread pool which is different from the highly-loaded thread pool that is associated with the external port which receives the pings.

(36) In another example, the Ping Result fails due to a connection failure, the Service Stopped Flag is False, the Operations Complete Flag is True, and the Health Status Metric is Unhealthy. As shown in FIG. 5, it may be presumed in such a scenario that the service is RUNNING but that its index server is stopped. Accordingly, an alert may be generated which specifies these presumptions, thereby assisting the operations team in resolving the issue.

(37) The Ping Result may also fail due to a connection failure while the Service Stopped Flag is False, the Operations Complete Flag is True, and the Health Status Metric is Healthy. In this scenario, it may be presumed that the service is RUNNING and that its proxy server is down. Again, a corresponding alert specifying these presumptions may be generated.

(38) FIG. 6 is a block diagram of architecture **600** to monitor service instances according to some embodiments. Architecture **600** may comprise an implementation of architecture **200** and/or may execute process **300** in some embodiments.

(39) Generally, orchestrator **610** manages the states of service instances (e.g., containerized applications) executing within clusters **620**, **630** and **640**. In the present example, cluster **620** executes database server instances, cluster **630** executes data lake instances, and cluster **640** executes both OLTP server instances and replication server instances.

(40) In order to provide scalability, orchestrator **610** includes one (or more) instance(s) of ping operator **660** to receive lifecycle operations **665** associated with service instances. Based on operations **665**, ping operator **660** controls assignment of one of product-specific ping agents **680** to a service instance. For example, if a lifecycle operation **665** calls for creation of a database server instance within cluster **620**, a ping operator **660** updates labels **672** to associate the database server instance with a ping agent **680** that corresponds to database server instances. The ping agent **680** reads labels **672** and configures itself to communicate with the instance using endpoint information **674** (which may specify a corresponding SQL port) and status information **676**.

(41) As described above, orchestrator **610** also obtains health metrics **621** acquired by health check component **622**. In the illustrated example, instances of health check component **622** acquire health metrics (e.g., reachability data) from internal ports of containerized applications **623** and store health metrics **621** using a time-series database **624**. Time-series database **624** may be federated across clusters and is therefore in federation with time-series database **615** of orchestrator **610** to periodically replicate its data thereto. Accordingly, thusly-received health metrics are stored in

health metrics **614** of data **611**.

(42) Also stored in data **611** of orchestrator **610** are ping results **613** obtained from ping agents **680** by database **615** (e.g., via a scraping API) and service metadata **612** indicating the status of the service instances of clusters **620**, **630**, **640**. Alert manager **616** uses data **611** and alert rules **617** to determine whether to generate alerts associated with the service instances and transmit the alerts to operations team **650**. Alert rules **617** may be product (i.e., service)-specific in some embodiments.

(43) FIG. 7 is a view of alert interface **700** presenting an alert according to some embodiments. Alert interface **700** may be presented to an operations team via a monitoring application, an electronic mail message, or any other suitable medium.

(44) Alert interface **700** includes area **710** specifying the particular service instance to which the alert is related, as well as a message “Check Health” indicating a type of the alert. Area **720** shown the metric values, metadata values and health metrics which resulted in generation of the alert. Embodiments are not limited to the form or content of alert interface **700**.

(45) FIG. 8 illustrates cloud-based database deployment **800** according to some embodiments. Each depicted node may comprise a separate physical machine or a virtual machine. Such virtual machines may be allocated by a public cloud provider providing self-service and immediate provisioning, autoscaling, security, compliance and identity management features.

(46) Orchestrator cluster nodes **810**, **811** and **812** may operate to perform operations attributed herein to an orchestrator, while database cluster nodes **820**, **821** and **822** and data lake cluster nodes **830**, **831** and **832** execute service instances which may be monitored as described herein.

(47) The foregoing diagrams represent logical architectures for describing processes according to some embodiments, and actual implementations may include more or different components arranged in other manners. Other topologies may be used in conjunction with other embodiments. Moreover, each component or device described herein may be implemented by any number of devices in communication via any number of other public and/or private networks. Two or more of such computing devices may be located remote from one another and may communicate with one another via any known manner of network(s) and/or a dedicated connection. Each component or device may comprise any number of hardware and/or software elements suitable to provide the functions described herein as well as any other functions. For example, any computing device used in an implementation of architecture **100** may include a programmable processor to execute program code such that the computing device operates as described herein.

(48) All systems and processes discussed herein may be embodied in program code stored on one or more non-transitory computer-readable media. Such media may include, for example, a DVD-ROM, a Flash drive, magnetic tape, and solid state Random Access Memory (RAM) or Read Only Memory (ROM) storage units. Embodiments are therefore not limited to any specific combination of hardware and software.

(49) Elements described herein as communicating with one another are directly or indirectly capable of communicating over any number of different systems for transferring data, including but not limited to shared memory communication, a local area network, a wide area network, a telephone network, a cellular network, a fiber-optic network, a satellite network, an infrared network, a radio frequency network, and any other type of network that may be used to transmit information between devices. Moreover, communication between systems may proceed over any one or more transmission protocols that are or become known, such as Asynchronous Transfer Mode (ATM), Internet Protocol (IP), Hypertext Transfer Protocol (HTTP) and Wireless Application Protocol (WAP).

(50) Embodiments described herein are solely for the purpose of illustration. Those in the art will recognize other embodiments may be practiced with modifications and alterations to that described above.

## Claims

1. A system comprising: an orchestrator comprising: a plurality of ping agents, where each of the plurality of ping agents is assignable only to a respective type of service and where a first one of the plurality of ping agents is assignable only to a first type of service and a second one of the plurality of ping agents is assignable only to a second type of service; and a ping operator to, in response to creation of a first instance of a first service, determine a type of the first service, determine a ping agent which is assignable only to the type of the first service, and assign the determined ping agent to the first instance of the first service to transmit a ping to an external port of the first instance and to determine a ping result corresponding to the transmitted ping; an execution environment to execute the first instance of the first service; a metadata store to store metadata indicating a status of the first instance of the first service; a health check component to determine a health status metric of the first instance and to provide the health status metric via an internal port of the execution environment; and an alert manager to determine whether to generate an alert associated with the first instance based on the ping result, the status, and the health status metric.
2. The system according to claim 1, wherein the execution environment is a container and the first instance of the first service is a containerized application.
3. The system according to claim 2, further comprising: a second container to execute a second instance of the first service, the second instance comprising a second containerized application, wherein the ping operator is to, in response to creation of the second instance of the first service, determine a second ping agent of the plurality of ping agents which is assignable to the type of the first service and assign the determined second ping agent to the second instance of the first service to transmit a second ping to a second external port of the second container and to determine a second ping result corresponding to the transmitted second ping, wherein the metadata store is to store metadata indicating a second status of the second containerized application, wherein the health check component is to determine a second health status metric of the second containerized application and to provide the second health status metric via an internal port of the second container, and wherein the alert manager is to determine whether to generate an alert associated with the second containerized application based on the second ping result, the second status, and the second health status metric.
4. A method comprising: instantiating a first instance of a first service in an execution environment; in response to instantiating the first instance of the first service, determining a type of the first service, determining, from a plurality of ping agents, where each of the plurality of ping agents is assignable only to a respective type of service, a ping agent which is assignable only to the type of the first service, and assigning the determined ping agent to the first instance of the first service; operating the ping agent to transmit a ping to an external port of the first instance; determining a ping result corresponding to the transmitted ping; storing metadata indicating a status of the first instance of the first service; determining a health status metric of the first instance and providing the health status metric via an internal port of the execution environment; and determining whether to generate an alert associated with the first instance based on the ping result, the status, and the health status metric, where a first one of the plurality of ping agents is assignable only to a first type of service and a second one of the plurality of ping agents is assignable only to a second type of service.
5. The method according to claim 4, wherein the execution environment is a container and the first instance of the first service is a containerized application.
6. The method according to claim 5, further comprising: instantiating a second instance of the first service in a second container, the second instance comprising a second containerized application; in response to instantiating the second instance of the first service, determining a second ping agent of



the plurality of ping agents which is assignable only to the type of the first service and assigning the determined second ping agent to the second instance of the first service; operating the second ping agent to transmit a second ping to a second external port of the second container; determining a second ping result corresponding to the transmitted second ping; storing metadata indicating a second status of the second containerized application; determining a second health status metric of the second containerized application and providing the second health status metric via an internal port of the second container; and determining whether to generate an alert associated with the second containerized application based on the second ping result, the second status, and the second health status metric.

7. A non-transitory computer-readable medium storing program code executable by one or more processing units to cause a computing system to: execute a first instance of a first service in an execution environment; in response to execution of the first instance of the first service, determine a type of the first service, determine, from a plurality of ping agents, where each of the plurality of ping agents is assignable only to a respective type of service, a ping agent of the plurality of ping agents which is assignable only to the type of the first service, and assign the determined ping agent to the first instance of the first service; operate the ping agent to transmit a ping to an external port of the first instance; determine a ping result corresponding to the transmitted ping; store metadata indicating a status of the first instance of the first service; determine a health status metric of the first instance and providing the health status metric via an internal port of the execution environment; and determine whether to generate an alert associated with the first instance based on the ping result, the status, and the health status metric, where a first one of the plurality of ping agents is assignable only to a first type of service and a second one of the plurality of ping agents is assignable only to a second type of service.

8. The medium according to claim 7, wherein the execution environment is a container and the first instance of the first service is a containerized application.

9. The medium according to claim 8, the program code executable by one or more processing units to cause a computing system to: execute a second instance of the first service in a second container, the second instance comprising a second containerized application; in response to execution of the second instance of the first service, determine a second ping agent of the plurality of ping agents which is assignable only to the type of the first service and assign the determined second ping agent to the second instance of the first service; operate the second ping agent to transmit a second ping to a second external port of the second container; determine a second ping result corresponding to the transmitted second ping; store metadata indicating a second status of the second containerized application; determine a second health status metric of the second containerized application and providing the second health status metric via an internal port of the second container; and determine whether to generate an alert associated with the second containerized application based on the second ping result, the second status, and the second health status metric.

---